Jiyoung Kim

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Placement Directors

Prof. Rui Castro	rui.castro@mcgill.ca	(514) 398-1226
Prof. Kensuke Sakamoto	kensuke.sakamoto@mcgill.ca	(438) 226-3871

Education

Ph.D. Economics — **McGill University**
Fall 2021–June 2027 (expected)

M.A. Economics — **Yonsei University**
Mar 2019–Feb 2021

B.A. Quantitative Risk Management and Economics — **Yonsei University**
Mar 2014–Aug 2018

Fields of Specialization

Primary: Macroeconomics
Secondary: Labor Economics

Dissertation

Firm-level Workforce Composition and Firm Dynamics
Supervisors: Prof. Rui Castro, Prof. Markus Poschke

Job Market Paper

"**Firm-level Workforce Composition and Firm Dynamics**"

Abstract.

Firms tend to improve productivity and expand their workforce as they age. But do they expand with better or worse workers than before? Using Canadian matched employer–employee data, I uncover two facts. First, firms tend to start with a small, high-quality workforce and grow by expanding into lower-quality workers. Second, longer-lived firms hire better workers at any age than shorter-lived firms. These findings suggest that high-quality workers are especially valuable early in a firm's life, shaping its growth and survival. Consistent with this view, I develop a firm dynamics model in which firms may improve firm-level productivity by accumulating organizational capital with high-quality workers. In the model, firms are also innately heterogeneous in their need for organizational capital, generating differentials in workforce quality and survival. I calibrate the model and use it to understand the role of high-quality workers not only at the firm level but also for aggregate productivity. In the last two decades, the Canadian economy has been falling behind the U.S., and I quantify whether the increasing cost of high-quality workers could explain the widening productivity gap. In Canada, the wage of top 1% workers relative to median workers has increased by approximately 10%. My model predicts a 1.7% loss in aggregate productivity, which explains 14% of the increased productivity gap. Reduced accumulation of organizational capital accounts for 80% of the long-run aggregate productivity loss.

Other Research Papers

- "**Predicting Labor Force Types**", NBER Working Paper (June, 2026) with Castro, Lange, Larivière and Poschke.
- "**Late Baby-Boomers and Early Millennials In and Out of Work**", submitted to *Canadian Journal of Economics* as part of the 2026 Innis Lecture with Castro, Lange, and Poschke

Teaching Experience

- Teaching Assistant, Econ 354: Macroeconomics — Honours 2, McGill University — 2026 W
- Teaching Assistant, Econ 450: Advanced Economic Theory 1, McGill University — 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026 W; 2026 F
- Teaching Assistant, Econ 713: Macroeconomic Theory 2 (Ph.D), McGill University — 2025 W
- Teaching Assistant, Econ 209: Macroeconomic Analysis & Applications, McGill University — 2025 Summer, 2025 F
- Teaching Assistant, Econ 332: Macroeconomic Theory — Majors 1, McGill University — 2024 F
- Teaching Assistant, Econ 208: Microeconomic Analysis & Applications, McGill University — 2022 F

Research and Relevant Work Experience

Research Assistant — **Korea Development Institute (KDI)**
Knowledge Sharing Program (KSP) — *Aug 2014–Apr 2016*

- Policy consultation for the Government of Belize on a national science, technology and innovation strategy
- Project report

Conference and Seminar Presentations

2026	CIREQ Lunch Seminar, McGill University, Aug
	T2M Student Workshop Program, HEC Montreal, June
	Canadian Economics Association, Simon Fraser University, May
	20th CIREQ–CIRANO PhD Students' Conference, CIRANO Montreal, May
	19th QICSS Emerging Excellence Conference, INRS, Apr
2025	CIREQ Lunch Seminar, McGill University, Nov
2024	Canadian Economics Association, Toronto Metropolitan University, May

Rewards and Grants

2021–2026	Graduate Excellence Award, McGill University
2026	Best Presentation Award, 19th QICSS Emerging Excellence Conference, INRS
2017	High Honors, Yonsei University

Languages

Korean (native), English (fluent), Spanish (advanced)

Computational Skills

Python, MATLAB, Stata, TensorFlow, Keras

References

Prof. Rui Castro	McGill University	rui.castro@mcgill.ca	(514) 398-1226
Prof. Markus Poschke	McGill University	markus.poschke@mcgill.ca	(514) 398-1233
Prof. Fabian Lange	McGill University	fabain.lange@mcgill.ca	(514) 653-0020